

Ilya Panko

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github.com/KOTKenny

Senior React Native Engineer with 5+ years shipping consumer mobile products — most recently an AI-powered fitness app live on the App Store.

I take features **end-to-end** — from an ambiguous problem and technical design through launch and iteration — working directly with **Product and Design**, in **TypeScript, React Native and Expo**, on iOS and Android.

Strong in **real-time, data-rich interfaces**, **rendering and performance on low-end devices**, **custom native modules in Swift and Kotlin**, and **AI features in production** (LangGraph, ElevenLabs), built with AI-assisted tooling (Cursor, Opencode, OpenRouter).

Senior React Native Engineer (Consumer Mobile • Product Engineering)

Skill Highlights

- **Languages:** TypeScript, JavaScript
- **Mobile:** React Native, Expo SDK 54, Expo Router, Reanimated, Gesture Handler, Lottie
- **Architecture & State:** Zustand, TanStack Query, Redux, MobX, feature modules, adapters
- **Native:** custom Expo modules (Swift, Kotlin), BLE, Apple Watch, GPS, background tasks
- **Data & Storage:** SQLite + Drizzle, repositories, migrations, offline sync, cache hydration
- **Real-time & Streaming:** streaming LLM responses, cancellable flows, Firebase
- **Performance:** virtualization, memoization, startup and memory profiling, low-end Android
- **Quality:** Jest, RN Testing Library, native unit tests (Gradle, XCTest), Sentry, Crashlytics
- **Release:** EAS Build / Update, App Store, Google Play, OTA channels
- **Auth & Payments:** AWS Cognito, Apple Sign-In, OAuth, RevenueCat
- **AI tooling:** LangGraph, ElevenLabs, OpenRouter, Cursor, Opencode

Languages

English - B2

Experience

Senior Frontend Engineer (React & React Native) Aug 2021 - Sep 2026

Elinext | Remote | Outsource, client products under NDA

Tech stack: React, React Native, Expo, TypeScript, Redux, MobX, React Query, React Navigation, Reanimated, Lottie, Firebase

Products: a healthcare records platform and a notes app with map, canvas and sharing

- Owned the **React Native client end-to-end** for both products on **iOS and Android**, alongside their **React web** counterparts
- Delivered the **healthcare records** surface: record lists, detail forms, validation, and explicit loading, empty and error states
- Built the **notes app**: creating and editing notes, freehand **canvas drawing**, a **map view** of where notes were left, and sharing notes between users
- Shipped **real-time updates** over Firebase, so shared notes appear without reopening the app
- Built **React / Next.js dashboards and internal tools** for operations teams, reusing the same design primitives as mobile
- Worked with designers on **interaction details and accessibility**; reviewed code and mentored junior developers

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Each product runs on **one React / React Native codebase** across web, iOS and Android, with no separate native apps to maintain
- Canvas drawing and long record lists stay smooth on low-end Android hardware after the rendering rework (virtualization and memoization)
- Kept React Native, React Navigation and Firebase on current major versions across repeated upgrades **without a release blocker**

Senior React Native Developer Aug 2025 - Mar 2026

Cadence | Remote | Contract

Tech stack: React Native 0.81, React 19, Expo 54, Expo Router, TypeScript, Zustand, TanStack Query, SQLite + Drizzle, AWS Cognito, RevenueCat, LangGraph, ElevenLabs, Sentry, EAS

- Shipped features in a production **AI running-coach app** live on the App Store, on Expo 54 / React Native 0.81 / React 19
- Built a **custom native module in Swift and Kotlin** that runs workout sessions on-device — BLE heart-rate sensors, Apple Watch and GPS pace tracking kept alive in the background — covered by unit tests on both platforms
- Implemented **AI coaching flows** on a LangGraph backend: streaming, cancellable responses and ElevenLabs voice prompts, without blocking the JS thread mid-workout
- Built **chat, program and analytics** screens on a feature-module architecture (**api → cache → state → hooks → ui**), with React Query for server state and Zustand for transient UI state
- Added **offline-first workout storage** on SQLite + Drizzle with repositories, migrations, cache hydration and background sync, so sessions survive app kills and poor connectivity
- Wired **release and delivery**: EAS Workflows with label-gated builds, store submission and OTA updates across sandbox and production variants

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Moved UI onto a **token-based design system** (Figma → TypeScript tokens), cutting routine feature build time by **~20%** and keeping screens consistent
- OTA channels let **JS fixes reach users without a store review**, while native changes still go through label-gated builds

Self Projects

Studhub

React 18, TypeScript, MUI, REST APIs, JWT

- Source code: github.com/KOTKenny
- Full-stack platform for **university students** with schedule management, a virtual economy and a marketplace
- Built the **frontend in React 18 + TypeScript + MUI** with reusable UI primitives and a modular component architecture

JobSearcher

React, TypeScript, Vite, .NET 9, SignalR, SQLite, OpenRouter

- Source code: github.com/KOTKenny
- Built a **React + TypeScript interface** for an LLM-powered job matching product, with structured match results, filtering and **real-time updates over SignalR**
- Engineered **deterministic prompts with validated JSON output** and fallbacks, treating model responses as untrusted input

Education

Electronics Engineer & Programmer
BSUIR, 2018-2022